Homemade Apple Cider

Apples, orange and spices slow-cooked, mashed and strained.

MAKES **ABOUT 1 1/2 QUARTS** · ACTIVE **20 MIN**
TOTAL **8 1/2 HOURS**

INGREDIENTS

10 medium	apples, a sweet and tart mix (about half Honeycrisp, half Granny Smith)
1	orange
4	cinnamon sticks (or 1 tbsp ground cinnamon)
1 tsp	ground cloves (or 2 tsp whole cloves)
6 tbsp	granulated sugar (75 g), or to taste
	water, just enough to cover

METHOD

1. Peel the orange and put only the segments into a 4-quart or larger slow cooker; peel and pith make the cider bitter. Quarter the apples, cut out the cores and add them, then the cinnamon, cloves and sugar.
2. Pour in water until the fruit is just covered. Any more dilutes the flavor.
3. Cover and cook on low for **6 to 7 hours** (the better option) or on high for **4 hours**, until the fruit is very soft.
4. Fish out the cinnamon sticks, mash the fruit thoroughly with a potato masher or sturdy spoon, then return the sticks and cover.
5. Cook **1 hour** more on either setting.
6. Strain slowly through a fine-mesh sieve into a pot or heatproof pitcher, then strain a second time to catch the remaining solids. Serve warm.

NOTES

- Apples: mix sweet (Jazz, Honeycrisp, Sugarbee, Pink Lady, Gala, Fuji, Cortland) with tart (Granny Smith, Braeburn, Jonathan, Pacific Rose). An all-tart batch comes out thin on sweetness and less balanced.
- Sugar: 1/4 cup (50 g) for a spicier cider, 1/2 cup (100 g) for store-bought sweetness. Brown sugar swaps in at the same amount. Honey works too; stir it in at the end until it tastes right.
- Whole cloves taste the same as ground but give a noticeably paler cider.
- Stovetop: combine everything in a large stockpot and bring to a simmer over high heat, stirring now and then. Cover, drop to medium-low and simmer **2 hours**, then mash, re-cover and simmer **1 hour** more. Leave headroom; a 5-quart Dutch oven can boil over under the lid.
- Storage: refrigerate up to **5 to 7 days** and rewarm on the stove, or drink it cold. Freezes up to **3 months**; ice cube trays make single servings. Thaw in the fridge.
- Leftover mash: use it like spiced applesauce in apple cake or muffins, trimming that recipe's sugar a little. Simmer it to thicken if it's watery.

FRUIT & SUGAR
SWEET · SLOW COOKER OR STOVETOP SIMMER
UNITED STATES

Adapted from Sally's Baking Addiction, sallysbakingaddiction.com/homemade-apple-cider. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.